

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Distance Is Not Access

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C24
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Measure health-service access through travel time, affordability, availability, acceptability, quality, disability, and geographic equity.

Why it matters

Straight-line distance can create a false picture of access and hide systematic exclusion.

Illustrative application

Two communities at equal distance have different access because roads, transport cost, opening hours, and service readiness differ.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.